

BUILDING YOUR BUSINESS FAMILY TREE

You can't have a successful business without a great team. But it isn't just who you've got that matters; it's the positions they're placed in. Make sure you pair the right people with the right jobs. Every business is different, but the following five roles are critical for any business, and definitely important in any family venture.

1. **The Bosshole.** Yes, it's exactly what it sounds like. ABC's *20/20* recently did a special on me in which they called me a Bosshole. It didn't hurt my feelings—I took it as a compliment! The Bosshole is the head of the company, though not necessarily the head of the family, and it's not a gender-specific role: women and men can both be Bossholes. The important thing is that the Bosshole can't be sentimental. As a Bosshole, you don't take any crap; you do what you have to do to achieve success for the business. Bossholes never make the mistake of thinking, "It's a family business so I've got to be nice." Be ruthless. Why? Because it's the kindest, smartest move you can make for your family dynasty.
2. **The Positive Partner.** The Positive Partner is the right-hand man (or woman) of the Bosshole. He or she should possess all the traits and skills the Bosshole lacks. This individual is probably the Bosshole's spouse or partner, though he or she may also be another family member with a complementary energy or skill set. The Positive Partner's job is to both support the Bosshole and offer a much-needed balance. You'll know it's a good partnership when the Bosshole has strengths the Positive Partner is lacking, and the Positive Partner has strengths the Bosshole is lacking.